

The Adventure of the Speckled Band

Arthur Conan Doyle · 1892

First published: The Strand, Feb 1892

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/The_Adventures_of_Sherlock_Holmes_(1892,_US)/The_Adventure_of_the_Speckled_Band (revision 15104245), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 9–12 (accessible text, well suited to the scaffolded-support track; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). The scaffolded-support track works from the full text with scaffolds. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does The Adventure of the Speckled Band suggest about reason and deduction?
- What does The Adventure of the Speckled Band suggest about greed and violence?
- What does The Adventure of the Speckled Band suggest about protection of the vulnerable?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the story in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the story quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* The Adventure of the Speckled Band	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*reason and deduction* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to The Adventure of the Speckled Band

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Arthur Conan Doyle's life or times connects to reason and deduction in “The Adventure of the Speckled Band”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (reason and deduction, greed and violence, protection of the vulnerable).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2

Author biography

Arthur Conan Doyle was born in Edinburgh on 22 May 1859, studied medicine at the University of Edinburgh, where his teacher Dr. Joseph Bell's powers of observation inspired Sherlock Holmes, and practised as a doctor in Southsea. Holmes first appeared in A Study in Scarlet (1887); the stories in The Strand Magazine from 1891 made him world-famous. Doyle also wrote historical stories and science fiction, served as a volunteer doctor in the Boer War, was knighted in 1902, and in later life became a passionate Spiritualist. He died on 7 July 1930.

Historical and cultural context

Victorian England combined new forensic science with fascination with the Empire, especially India. The story's villain is a doctor who practised in Calcutta and keeps exotic animals.

Publication and reception, then and now

First published in The Strand Magazine in February 1892; collected in The Adventures of Sherlock Holmes (1892).

Then: Very popular; Doyle later named it his favourite Holmes story.

Now: A model locked-room mystery for teaching inference and clues.

Overview (spoiler-free)

Helen Stoner comes to Holmes in terror: her twin sister died mysteriously two years earlier, crying out about "the speckled band," and now Helen hears the same strange whistle at night.

Main themes

- deduction and reason.
- greed.
- violence recoils on the violent.

Why it matters

Students practise inference and learn how mysteries plant clues fairly.

Spoilers · teacher only

Holmes finds that the stepfather, Dr. Grimesby Roylott, sent a venomous snake through a ventilator to kill the sisters for their inheritance; the snake turns on Roylott and kills him.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Before we open The Adventure of the Speckled Band: What clues can you tell about a person from their appearance?
Prompt: Before we open The Adventure of the Speckled Band: What clues can you tell about a person from their appearance?

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
locked-room mystery; red herring; clue; foreshadowing; deduction.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).
About the author. Arthur Conan Doyle was born in Edinburgh on 22 May 1859, studied medicine at the University of Edinburgh, where his teacher Dr. Joseph Bell's powers of observation inspired Sherlock Holmes, and practised as a doctor in Southsea. Holmes first appeared in A Study in Scarlet (1887); the stories in The Strand Magazine from 1891 made him world-famous. Doyle also wrote historical stories and science fiction, served as a volunteer doctor in the Boer War, was knighted in 1902, and in later life became a passionate Spiritualist. He died on 7 July 1930. The world of the book. Victorian England combined new forensic science with fascination with the Empire, especially India. The story's villain is a doctor who practised in Calcutta and keeps exotic animals. Publication and reception. First published in The Strand Magazine in February 1892; collected in The Adventures of Sherlock Holmes (1892). Then: Very popular; Doyle later named it his favourite Holmes story. Now: A model locked-room mystery for teaching inference and clues.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "It is fear, Mr. Holmes. It is terror" slowly and put it in my own words: The frightened client says her shivering comes from fear and terror. Next, craft. I notice two short matching sentences, which sound like someone too frightened to speak in long ones. The strongest word is "terror": Doyle chooses the strongest word available so the mystery opens at full pitch. Then, effect. How does this short speech set up the kind of story this is? My answer: It tells us the detective story will be about danger to a vulnerable person, with Holmes's calm reasoning set against her fear.

> *It is fear, Mr. Holmes. It is terror (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 11)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "It is fear, Mr. Holmes. It is terror" slowly and put it in my own words: The frightened client says her shivering comes from fear and terror. Next, craft. I notice two short matching sentences, which sound like someone too frightened to speak in long ones. The strongest word is "terror": Doyle chooses the strongest word available so the mystery opens at full pitch. Then, effect. How does this short speech set up the kind of story this is? My answer: It tells us the detective story will be about danger to a vulnerable person, with Holmes's calm reasoning set against her fear.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): Helen Stoner comes to Holmes in terror: her twin sister died mysteriously two years earlier, crying out about "the speckled band," and now Helen hears the same strange whistle at night. Themes to track: deduction and reason.: greed.: violence recoils on the violent.:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Page: reason and deduction. Prediction: Holmes will notice small physical details at Stoke Moran that everyone else ignores. Question: what clue in Helen Stoner's first account will turn out to matter most?
Task: Set up a reading journal for The Adventure of the Speckled Band: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Page: reason and deduction. Prediction: Holmes will notice small physical details at Stoke Moran that everyone else ignores. Question: what clue in Helen Stoner's first account will turn out to matter most?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does The Adventure of the Speckled Band still matter? Students practise inference and learn how mysteries plant clues fairly.
Anchor question: Why might The Adventure of the Speckled Band still be taught today?
Facilitation: Students practise inference and learn how mysteries plant clues fairly.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Doyle was a trained doctor who modeled Holmes partly on his teacher Dr. Joseph Bell. How does that background show in the way Holmes solves cases? Answer: Accept answers such as: Holmes reads small physical clues the way a doctor reads symptoms; he reasons from observation to diagnosis; he notices details (mud, a train ticket) other people miss.
Exit ticket: Doyle was a trained doctor who modeled Holmes partly on his teacher Dr. Joseph Bell. How does that background show in the way Holmes solves cases?
Answer: Accept answers such as: Holmes reads small physical clues the way a doctor reads symptoms; he reasons from observation to diagnosis; he notices details (mud, a train ticket) other people miss.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: The Adventure of the Speckled Band.

Teacher notes · sources: Arthur Conan Doyle Encyclopedia (https://www.arthur-conan-doyle.com/); Britannica, "Sir Arthur Conan Doyle" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Arthur-Conan-Doyle); Arthur Conan Doyle Encyclopedia (https://www.arthur-conan-doyle.com/)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- Note for teachers: the "swamp adder" is not a real species; real snakes cannot hear whistles or climb ropes as described.

Lesson 2: The Adventure of the Speckled Band

Focus: reason defeating a hidden crime

Objective: Students will analyze how foreshadowing develops in “The Adventure of the Speckled Band” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (murder, domestic abuse implied, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Sensitive content: Murder; domestic abuse implied. Preview the story, tell students in advance, and allow a pass on reading aloud. Keep discussion on how the writer uses these elements, not on graphic detail. This section mentions drinking or a drug (“… er whole figure swaying to and fro like that of a drunkard. I ran to her and threw my arms round h…”). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: Heads-up: this story includes murder; domestic abuse implied.
Suggested language: “Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Helen Stoner fears for her life: her twin sister Julia died two years before, crying 'It was the band! The speckled band!' Now her violent stepfather, Dr. Grimesby Roylott, has moved her into Julia's room. Holmes and Watson notice a dummy bell-rope, a ventilator and a bed bolted to the floor. They wait in the dark; Holmes strikes at a swamp adder sent through the ventilator. The snake turns and kills Roylott, who had wanted the girls' inheritance.

Background: Published in The Strand in February 1892. Doyle's Holmes popularized deductive detective fiction.

Significance: Doyle's own favorite Holmes story and a staple for teaching clues and inference.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How do you figure out the truth when the facts seem impossible? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to violence recoils on the violent because.... Content note before we start: Heads-up: this story includes murder; domestic abuse implied.
Prompt: How do you figure out the truth when the facts seem impossible?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to violence recoils on the violent because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Roylott dies by his own weapon.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: pittance — an inadequate payment; protruding — extend out or project in space; bequeathed — leave or give by will after one's death; impassable — incapable of being passed; revolved — turn on or around an axis or a center.
Words: pittance: an inadequate payment · protruding: extend out or project in space · bequeathed: leave or give by will after one's death · impassable: incapable of being passed · revolved: turn on or around an axis or a center

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Published in The Strand in February 1892. Doyle's Holmes popularized deductive detective fiction. Doyle's own favorite Holmes story and a staple for teaching clues and inference. Plot: Classic structure: client's story, investigation, night watch, solution. Foreshadowing: The ventilator, the bell-rope and the milk are planted early. Characterization: Roylott's violent temper (he bends a poker) contrasts with Holmes's calm. Watch for the speckled band: a misleading clue (Gypsies' scarves) that turns out to be a snake.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "It is fear, Mr. Holmes. It is terror" slowly and put it in my own words: Helen tells Holmes that she is not shivering from cold but from fear and terror. Next, craft. I notice the repeated frame "It is fear... It is terror," which climbs from a milder word to a stronger one. The strongest word is "terror": it names a fear that has taken over completely, worse than ordinary fear. Then, effect. What does Helen Stoner's answer tell Holmes about why she has come? My answer: Helen Stoner's answer that it is not cold that makes her shiver but fear tells Holmes she has come because her life is in danger; her body is reacting to a real threat, not imagination.

> *It is fear, Mr. Holmes. It is terror* *(The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 11)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "It is fear, Mr. Holmes. It is terror" slowly and put it in my own words: Helen tells Holmes that she is not shivering from cold but from fear and terror. Next, craft. I notice the repeated frame "It is fear... It is terror," which climbs from a milder word to a stronger one. The strongest word is "terror": it names a fear that has taken over completely, worse than ordinary fear. Then, effect. What does Helen Stoner's answer tell Holmes about why she has come? My answer: Helen Stoner's answer that it is not cold that makes her shiver but fear tells Holmes she has come because her life is in danger; her body is reacting to a real threat, not imagination.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The repeated cry "The band! the speckled band" misleads at first; its meaning is revealed only at the end. Ask: How does this line connect to violence recoils on the violent? Expected: Roylott dies by his own weapon. (The clue.)

> *the band! The speckled band (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 50)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The repeated cry "The band! the speckled band" misleads at first; its meaning is revealed only at the end.
Ask: How does this line connect to violence recoils on the violent?
Expected answer: Roylott dies by his own weapon. (The clue.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the story for plot, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about reason defeating a hidden crime? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Adventure of the Speckled Band develops the idea of reason defeating a hidden crime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and point of view shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. When the text says “Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent” (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 245), it shows this directly. Holmes drives the snake back, and it kills Roylott; Holmes concludes, "Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent."
Task: Annotate the story for plot, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about reason defeating a hidden crime? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Adventure of the Speckled Band develops the idea of reason defeating a hidden crime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and point of view shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. When the text says “Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent” (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 245), it shows this directly. Holmes drives the snake back, and it kills Roylott; Holmes concludes, "Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How do you figure out the truth when the facts seem impossible? Ask: does Holmes bear any responsibility for Roylott's death?
Anchor question: How do you figure out the truth when the facts seem impossible?
Facilitation: Ask: does Holmes bear any responsibility for Roylott's death?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about reason defeating a hidden crime? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. ("Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent", The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 245). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about reason defeating a hidden crime? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. ("Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent", The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 245). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how plot shapes reason defeating a hidden crime. Key takeaway: Roylott dies by his own weapon.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** Classic structure: client's story, investigation, night watch, solution.
- **Foreshadowing:** The ventilator, the bell-rope and the milk are planted early.
- **Characterization:** Roylott's violent temper (he bends a poker) contrasts with Holmes's calm.

Themes and how they develop

- **violence recoils on the violent:** Roylott dies by his own weapon.

Symbols and motifs

- **the speckled band:** a misleading clue (Gypsies' scarves) that turns out to be a snake.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "It is fear, Mr. Holmes. It is terror" (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 11) Atmosphere.
- "the band! The speckled band" (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 50) The clue.
- "Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent" (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 245) The moral.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created.
Evidence: "Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent" (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 245)

Reasoning: Holmes drives the snake back, and it kills Roylott; Holmes concludes, "Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
pittance (noun)	an inadequate payment	*It is evident, therefore, that if both girls had married, this beauty would have had a mere pittance, while even one of them would cripple him to a very serious extent.*	
protruding (verb)	extend out or project in space	*Grimesby Roylott, clad in a long gray dressing-gown, his bare ankles protruding beneath, and his feet thrust into red heelless Turkish slippers.*	
bequeathed (verb)	leave or give by will after one's death	*She had a considerable sum of money —not less than £1000 a year—and this she bequeathed to Dr.*	
impassable (adjective)	incapable of being passed	*"Yet if the lady is correct in saying that the flooring and walls are sound, and that the door, window, and chimney are impassable, then her sister must have been undoubtedly alone when she met her mysterious end."*	
revolved (verb)	turn on or around an axis or a center	*As I ran down the passage, my sister's door was unlocked, and revolved slowly upon its hinges.*	
narrowly (adverb)	closely; carefully	*In a fit of anger, however, caused by some robberies which had been perpetrated in the house, he beat his native butler to death, and narrowly escaped a capital sentence.*	“narrowly”: Origin: an English formation from narrow + -ly. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/narrowly#Etymology)
coincidence (noun)	an event that might have been arranged although it was really accidental	*"Well, there is at least a curious coincidence of dates.*	“coincidence”: Origin: Middle French coincidence. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/coincidence#Etymology)
headache (noun)	a pain in the head	*"You must confine yourself to your room, on pretence of a headache, when your step-father comes back.*	

fireplace (noun)	an open recess in a wall at the base of a chimney where a fire can be built	*"See that you keep yourself out of my grip," he snarled, and hurling the twisted poker into the fireplace, he strode out of the room.*	
consulted (verb)	get or ask advice from	*Holmes turned to his desk, and unlocking it, drew out a small case-book, which he consulted.*	"consulted": Origin of "consult": Middle French consulter; earlier Latin cōnsultum. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/consult#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. How do you figure out the truth when the facts seem impossible?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with reason and deduction?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who comes to Holmes for help? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Helen Stoner
2. What were Julia's last words? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It was the band! The speckled band!
3. What strange detail does Holmes find in the room? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A dummy bell-rope by a ventilator and a bed clamped to the floor
4. What is the 'speckled band'? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A swamp adder
5. What was Roylott's motive? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To keep the stepdaughters' inheritance
6. Retell the three most important events of "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Helen Stoner fears for her life: her twin sister Julia died two years before, crying 'It was the band! The speckled band!' Now her violent stepfather, Dr. Grimesby Roylott, has moved her into Julia's room. Holmes and Watson notice a dummy bell-rope, a ventilator and a bed bolted to the floor. They wait in the dark; Holmes strikes at a swamp adder sent through the ventilator. The snake turns and…
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "The Adventure of the Speckled Band"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.

8. Where and when does “The Adventure of the Speckled Band” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: “It is evident, therefore, that if both girls had married, this beauty would have had a mere pittance, while even one of them would cripple him to a very serious extent.” What does “pittance” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: pittance: an inadequate payment.
10. Reread: “Grimesby Roylott, clad in a long gray dressing-gown, his bare ankles protruding beneath, and his feet thrust into red heelless Turkish slippers.” What does “protruding” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: protruding: extend out or project in space.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “The Adventure of the Speckled Band” suggest about reason defeating a hidden crime? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Doyle's own favorite Holmes story and a staple for teaching clues and inference.
2. Find one example of foreshadowing in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
3. How does the point of view in this story shape what we understand about reason defeating a hidden crime? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. Useful evidence: “It is fear, Mr. Holmes. It is terror” (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 11): Atmosphere. Theme link: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “"You must confine yourself to your room, on pretence of a headache, when your step-father comes back.”, why might Doyle have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “The Adventure of the Speckled Band”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Helen Stoner fears for her life: her twin sister Julia died two years before, crying 'It was the band! The speckled band!' Now her violent stepfather, Dr. Grimesby Roylott, has moved her into Julia's room. Holmes and Watson notice a dummy bell-rope, a ventilator and a bed bolted to the floor. They…
6. As the opening story, what does “The Adventure of the Speckled Band” set up that the rest of The Adventure of the Speckled Band will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. Useful evidence: “the band! The speckled band” (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 50): The clue. Theme link: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a

quoted line.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. Useful evidence: “Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent” (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 245): The moral. On characterization: Roylott's violent temper (he bends a poker) contrasts with Holmes's calm. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: “How do you figure out the truth when the facts seem impossible?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does plot appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with reason and deduction? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. Useful evidence: “It is fear, Mr. Holmes. It is terror” (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 11): Atmosphere. On plot: Classic structure: client's story, investigation, night watch, solution. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Published in The Strand in February 1892. Doyle's Holmes popularized deductive detective fiction. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. Useful evidence: “the band! The speckled band” (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 50): The clue. Theme link: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Doyle's own favorite Holmes story and a staple for teaching clues and inference.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. Useful evidence: “Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent” (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 245): The moral. Theme link: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. Useful evidence: “It is fear, Mr. Holmes. It is terror” (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 11): Atmosphere. On characterization: Roylott's violent temper (he bends a poker) contrasts with Holmes's calm. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “The Adventure of the Speckled Band” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about reason defeating a hidden crime? [DOK 4 ·

thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. Useful evidence: "the band! The speckled band" (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 50): The clue. Theme link: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about "The Adventure of the Speckled Band": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. Useful evidence: "Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent" (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 245): The moral. Theme link: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this story to greed and violence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Doyle need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. Useful evidence: "It is fear, Mr. Holmes. It is terror" (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 11): Atmosphere. Theme link: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the foreshadowing in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. Useful evidence: "the band! The speckled band" (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 50): The clue. On foreshadowing: The ventilator, the bell-rope and the milk are planted early. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" treats reason defeating a hidden crime with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Adventure of the Speckled Band see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. Useful evidence: "Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent" (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 245): The moral. Theme link: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. As the final story, does this ending resolve reason and deduction? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. Useful evidence: "It is fear, Mr. Holmes. It is terror" (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 11): Atmosphere. On foreshadowing: The ventilator, the bell-rope and the milk are planted early. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about reason defeating a hidden crime? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. Useful evidence: "the band! The speckled band" (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 50): The clue. Theme link: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Arthur Conan Doyle about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. Useful evidence: "Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent" (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 245): The moral. Theme link: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Point of view**: who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who comes to Holmes for help?
   A. Julia Stoner
   B. Dr. Roylott
   C. Mrs. Hudson
   D. Helen Stoner
   Key: D (Helen Stoner)
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 33: "The bedrooms in this wing are on the ground floor, the sitting-rooms being in the central block of the _____." Word bank: buildings, understand, objections, branches
   Key: buildings
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "In a fit of anger, however, caused by some robberies which had been perpetrated in the house, he beat his native butler to death, and _____ escaped a capital sentence." Word bank: protruding, bequeathed, pittance, narrowly
   Key: narrowly
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "'You must confine yourself to your room, on pretence of a _____, when your step-father comes back." Word bank: protruding, bequeathed, headache, pittance
   Key: headache

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 118? “From amid the _____ there jutted out the gray gables and high roof-tree of a very old mansion.”

   A. investigations

   B. buildings

   C. branches

   D. surrounds

   Key: C (branches)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What strange detail does Holmes find in the room?

   A. A hidden door

   B. A bloody knife

   C. A dummy bell-rope by a ventilator and a bed clamped to the floor

   D. A broken window

   Key: C (A dummy bell-rope by a ventilator and a bed clamped to the floor)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “‘Well, there is at least a curious _____ of dates.” Word bank: protruding, bequeathed, coincidence, pittance

   Key: coincidence

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 94: “I want to see whether the _____ are fatal, or if they may be explained away.” Word bank: standing, buildings, objections, branches

   Key: objections

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 245: “Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the _____”

   Key: violent

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What was Roylott's motive?

    A. Revenge

    B. Madness

    C. Jealousy

    D. To keep the stepdaughters' inheritance

    Key: D (To keep the stepdaughters' inheritance)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “the band! The speckled band” (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 50) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The clue. The evidence is “the band! The speckled band” (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 50). This develops violence recoils on the violent: Roylott dies by his own weapon.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 5 reveal about the character or situation? “Now, when young ladies wander about the metropolis at this hour of the morning, and knock sleepy people up out of their beds, I presume that it is something very pressing which they have to communicate.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 5) shows the situation turning on reason and deduction: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The words “communicate” and “metropolis” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 126 reveal about the character or situation? “Our client of the morning had hurried forward to meet us with a face which spoke her joy.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 126) shows the situation turning on reason and deduction: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The words “morning” and “hurried” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 141 shapes its tone: “Holmes refused to examine the third chamber, so we passed at once to the second, that in which Miss Stoner was now sleeping, and in which her sister had met with her fate.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “sleeping” and “refused” (paragraph 141) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to reason and deduction: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 19 shapes its tone: “As to reward, my profession is its own reward; but you are at liberty to defray whatever expenses I may be put to, at the time which suits you best.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “profession” and “expenses” (paragraph 19) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to reason and deduction: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 67 to the story's treatment of reason and deduction: “His name is Armitage— Percy Armitage—the second son of Mr. Armitage, of Crane Water, near Reading.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 67) develops reason and deduction: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Its words “second” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “If we were to come to Stoke Moran to-day, would it be possible for us to see over these rooms without the knowledge of…” (paragraph 76), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating reason and deduction as central.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 65? “Holmes shook his head like a man who is far from being _____.”

    A. stepped
    B. investigations
    C. started
    D. satisfied

    Key: D (satisfied)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 17? “Oh, sir, do you not think that you could help me, too, and at least throw a little light through the dense darkness which _____ me?”

    A. branches
    B. surrounds
    C. return
    D. investigations

    Key: B (surrounds)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What were Julia's last words?

    A. The gypsies!

    B. The doctor did it

    C. Help me, Helen!

    D. It was the band! The speckled band!

    Key: D (It was the band! The speckled band!)

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 11: “It is fear, Mr. Holmes. It is _____”

    Key: terror

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 35 shapes its tone: “That fatal night Dr. Roylott had gone to his room early, though we knew that he had not retired to rest, for my sister was troubled by the smell of the strong Indian cigars which it was his custom to smoke.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “troubled” and “retired” (paragraph 35) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to reason and deduction: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 168 shapes its tone: “That is quite settled,’ said he, rising and putting his lens in his pocket.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “putting” and “settled” (paragraph 168) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to reason and deduction: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “the band! The speckled band” (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 50) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The clue. The evidence is “the band! The speckled band” (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 50). This develops violence recoils on the violent: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The words “speckled” and “band” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Holmes drives the snake back, and it kills Roylott; Holmes concludes, "Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent.".

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “As I ran down the passage, my sister's door was unlocked, and _____ slowly upon its hinges.” Word bank: pittance, revolved, protruding, bequeathed

    Key: revolved

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent” (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 245).

    Sample answer: Holmes drives the snake back, and it kills Roylott; Holmes concludes, "Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent.". The evidence is “Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent” (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 245) — The moral. This develops violence recoils on the violent: Roylott dies by his own weapon.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 226 to the story's treatment of reason and deduction: “My companion noiselessly closed the shutters, moved the lamp onto the table, and cast his eyes round the room.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 226) develops reason and deduction: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Its words "noiselessly" and "companion" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Then he turned down the lamp, and we were left in darkness." (paragraph 233), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating reason and deduction as central.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 95 to the story's treatment of reason and deduction: "So tall was he that his hat actually brushed the cross bar of the doorway, and his breadth seemed to span it across from side to side." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 95) develops reason and deduction: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Its words "actually" and "doorway" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "It was nearly one o'clock when Sherlock Holmes returned from his excursion." (paragraph 114), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating reason and deduction as central.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What is the 'speckled band'?

    A. A gypsy scarf

    B. A swamp adder

    C. A necklace

    D. A ribbon

    Key: B (A swamp adder)

29. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 2: "It was early in April in the year '83 that I woke one morning to find Sherlock Holmes _____, fully dressed, by the side of my bed." Word bank: branches, stepped, objections, standing

    Key: standing

30. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? "It is fear, Mr. Holmes. It is terror" (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 11) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Atmosphere. The evidence is "It is fear, Mr. Holmes. It is terror" (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 11). This develops violence recoils on the violent: Roylott dies by his own weapon.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 208 to the story's treatment of reason and deduction: "You remember in her statement she said that her sister could smell Dr. Roylott's cigar." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 208) develops reason and deduction: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Its words "statement" and "remember" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "This man strikes even deeper, but I think, Watson, that we shall be able to strike deeper still." (paragraph 218), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating reason and deduction as central.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how violence recoils on the violent develops from the opening of "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" to its ending. Use one quotation from each part.

    Sample answer: Near the start, "It is fear, Mr. Holmes. It is terror" (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 11) — Atmosphere. Later, "Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent" (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 245) — The moral. Roylott dies by his own weapon.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "It is fear, Mr. Holmes. It is terror" (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 11) shape its meaning? Consider

a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Atmosphere. The evidence is “It is fear, Mr. Holmes. It is terror” (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 11). This develops violence recoils on the violent: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The words “terror” and “fear” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Holmes drives the snake back, and it kills Roylott; Holmes concludes, "Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent.".

34. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] In the line “Grimesby Roylott, clad in a long gray dressing-gown, his bare ankles protruding beneath, and his feet thrust into red heelless Turkish slippers.”, what does “protruding” most nearly mean?

    A. an inadequate payment

    B. incapable of being passed

    C. leave or give by will after one's death

    D. extend out or project in space

    Key: D (extend out or project in space)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Which literary element does this describe in “The Adventure of the Speckled Band”? The ventilator, the bell-rope and the milk are planted early.

    A. Foreshadowing

    B. Tone / mood

    C. Symbolism

    D. Simile

    Key: A (Foreshadowing)

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which choice best states a central concern of “The Adventure of the Speckled Band”?

    A. A story so convincing it becomes real

    B. What fifteen years of solitude teach

    C. Reason defeating a hidden crime

    D. A reversal that punishes a change of heart

    Key: C (Reason defeating a hidden crime)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent” (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 245). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The moral. The evidence is “Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent” (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 245). This develops violence recoils on the violent: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The words “violent” and “recoil” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

38. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “The Adventure of the Speckled Band”? Classic structure: client's story, investigation, night watch, solution.

    A. Plot

    B. Setting

    C. Conflict

    D. Metaphor

    Key: A (Plot)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	9, 10, 17, 7, 18, 1, 8, 3, 19, 20, 12, 13, 21, 14, 22, 23	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	18, 19, 24, 17, 3, 1, 10, 6, 12, 11, 13, 14, 21, 25, 26, 27	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	28, 1, 5, 29, 2, 8, 19, 12, 30, 13, 21, 15, 14, 22, 31, 32	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	19, 18, 1, 6, 3, 8, 13, 11, 12, 14, 22, 21, 15, 16, 33, 26	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	24, 28, 9, 1, 19, 6, 12, 22, 15, 21, 14, 31, 27, 26, 16, 32	recall 6, inference 1, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	34, 10, 1, 24, 3, 12, 25, 22, 35, 14, 21, 27, 33, 26, 31, 16	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	10, 7, 24, 1, 5, 36, 11, 13, 21, 22, 15, 14, 31, 27, 26, 16	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	24, 34, 3, 1, 19, 6, 21, 15, 22, 37, 31, 26, 33, 32, 27, 16	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 6
College Senior	10, 1, 19, 20, 4, 13, 22, 35, 37, 14, 15, 21, 31, 16, 27, 26	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 6, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	10, 24, 1, 19, 3, 12, 11, 37, 38, 21, 14, 22, 26, 31, 16, 27	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Adventure of the Speckled Band,” how does Doyle show reason defeating a hidden crime? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In The Adventure of the Speckled Band, how does Doyle develop the idea of reason defeating a hidden crime? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how The Adventure of the Speckled Band develops the idea of reason defeating a hidden crime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and point of view shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of The Adventure of the Speckled Band (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of reason defeating a hidden crime. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what The Adventure of the Speckled Band suggests about reason defeating a hidden crime. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's foreshadowing and point of view), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Arthur Conan Doyle uses foreshadowing in The Adventure of the Speckled Band to complicate the reader's

understanding of reason defeating a hidden crime. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate The Adventure of the Speckled Band within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of reason defeating a hidden crime responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read The Adventure of the Speckled Band alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of reason defeating a hidden crime follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Adventure of the Speckled Band and its treatment of reason defeating a hidden crime. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's foreshadowing and point of view, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads The Adventure of the Speckled Band as evidence for a larger claim about reason defeating a hidden crime in The Adventure of the Speckled Band. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads The Adventure of the Speckled Band as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of reason defeating a hidden crime. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Adventure of the Speckled Band.

SAT-style questions

1. *She had a considerable sum of money—not less than £1000 a year—and this she bequeathed to Dr.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “bequeathed” most nearly mean?

   A. get or ask advice from

   B. a pain in the head

   C. leave or give by will after one's death

   D. an open recess in a wall at the base of a chimney where a fire can be built

2. *"You must confine yourself to your room, on pretence of a headache, when your step-father comes back. Then when you hear him retire for the night, you must open the shutters of your window, undo the hasp, put your lamp there as a signal to us, and then withdraw quietly with everything which you are likely to want into the room which you used to occupy. I have no doubt that, in spite of the repairs, you could manage there for one night."*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “The Adventure of the Speckled Band”?

   A. A girl choosing nature over a stranger's approval

   B. A symbol of hidden sin that isolates its wearer

C. Superstition used against a credulous man

D. Reason defeating a hidden crime

SAT key: 1. C (leave or give by will after one's death); 2. D (Reason defeating a hidden crime)

Unit test

The Adventure of the Speckled Band: end test · 90 minutes · 18 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 72: “Five little livid spots, the marks of four _____ and a thumb, were printed upon the white wrist.” Word bank: stepped, branches, fingers, standing

   Key: fingers
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 116: “It was a _____ day, with a bright sun and a few fleecy clouds in the heavens.” Word bank: started, buildings, branches, perfect

   Key: perfect
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 14: “You must have _____ early, and yet you had a good drive in a dog-cart, along heavy roads, before you reached the station.’” Word bank: objections, return, investigations, started

   Key: started
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 7? “Ihad no keener pleasure than in following Holmes in his professional _____, and in admiring the rapid deductions, as swift as intuitions, and yet always founded on a logical basis, with which he unravelled the problems which were submitted to him.”

   A. investigations

   B. thoroughly

   C. stepped

   D. buildings

   Key: A (investigations)
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 56: “The walls were carefully sounded, and were shown to be quite solid all round, and the flooring was also _____ examined, with the same result.” Word bank: buildings, surrounds, thoroughly, wickedness

   Key: thoroughly
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 40? “I cannot tell where it came from—_____ from the next room, perhaps from the lawn.”

   A. started

   B. perhaps

C. return

D. investigations

Key: B (perhaps)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 81? “But I shall _____ by the twelve o'clock train, so as to be there in time for your coming.’”

   A. investigations

   B. fingers

   C. return

   D. standing

   Key: C (return)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 110? “See here.’ He _____ swiftly forward, seized the poker, and bent it into a curve with his huge brown hands.”

   A. stepped

   B. standing

   C. thoroughly

   D. perhaps

   Key: A (stepped)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 30? “You can _____ that, living the life which I have described, we were little likely to see anyone of our own age and position.”

   A. return

   B. started

   C. standing

   D. understand

   Key: D (understand)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 20: “But I have heard, Mr. Holmes, that you can see deeply into the manifold _____ of the human heart.” Word bank: wickedness, surrounds, return, buildings

    Key: wickedness

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 157 reveal about the character or situation? “With your permission, Miss Stoner, we shall now carry our researches into the inner apartment.’” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 157) shows the situation turning on protection of the vulnerable: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The words “researches” and “permission” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 218 reveal about the character or situation? “This man strikes even deeper, but I think, Watson, that we shall be able to strike deeper still.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 218) shows the situation turning on greed and violence: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The words “strikes” and “strike” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 76 reveal about the character or situation? “If we were to come to Stoke Moran to-day, would it be possible for us to see over these rooms without the knowledge of your step-father?’” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 76) shows the situation turning on greed and violence: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The words “knowledge” and “possible” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in the story?

    A. “Oh, sir, do you not think that you could help me, too, and at least throw a little light through the dense darkness which surrounds me?”

    B. “You must have started early, and yet you had a good drive in a dog-cart, along heavy roads, before you reached the station.’”

    C. “Sir, I can stand this strain no longer; I shall go mad if it continues.”

    D. “As to reward, my profession is its own reward; but you are at liberty to defray whatever expenses I may be put to, at the time which suits…”

    Key: B (“You must have started early, and yet you had a good drive in a dog-cart, along heavy roads, before you reached the station.’”)

15. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 30 reveal about the character or situation? “My step-father learned of the engagement when my sister returned, and offered no objection to the marriage; but within a fortnight of the day which had been fixed for the wedding, the terrible event occurred which has deprived me of my…” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 30) shows the situation turning on protection of the vulnerable: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The words “engagement” and “companion” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

16. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 8 shapes its tone: “This is my intimate friend and associate, Dr. Watson, before whom you can speak as freely as before myself.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “associate” and “intimate” (paragraph 8) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to greed and violence: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

17. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 195 shapes its tone: “At dusk we saw Dr. Grimesby Roylott drive past, his huge form looming up beside the little figure of the lad who drove him.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “looming” and “little” (paragraph 195) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to protection of the vulnerable: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 148 to the story's treatment of greed and violence: “You will excuse me for a few minutes while I satisfy myself as to this floor.’ He threw himself down upon his face with his lens in his hand, and crawled swiftly backward and forward, examining minutely the cracks between the boards.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 148) develops greed and violence: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Its words “examining” and “minutely” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “With your permission, Miss

Stoner, we shall now carry our researches into the inner apartment.'" (paragraph 157), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating greed and violence as central.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 114 shapes its tone: "It was nearly one o'clock when Sherlock Holmes returned from his excursion." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "excursion" and "returned" (paragraph 114) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to greed and violence: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 139 to the story's treatment of protection of the vulnerable: "Now, would you have the kindness to go into your room and bar your shutters.'" Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 139) develops protection of the vulnerable: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Its words "shutters" and "kindness" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Holmes refused to examine the third chamber, so we passed at once to the second, that in which Miss Stoner was now…" (paragraph 141), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating protection of the vulnerable as central.

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 85 shapes its tone: "It seems to me to be a most dark and sinister business." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "sinister" and "business" (paragraph 85) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to protection of the vulnerable: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 221 shapes its tone: "A moment later we were out on the dark road, a chill wind blowing in our faces, and one yellow light twinkling in front of us through the gloom to guide us on our sombre errand." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "twinkling" and "through" (paragraph 221) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to protection of the vulnerable: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 235 to the story's treatment of protection of the vulnerable: "Suddenly there was the momentary gleam of a light up in the direction of the ventilator, which vanished immediately, but was succeeded by a strong smell of burning oil and heated metal." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 235) develops protection of the vulnerable: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Its words "immediately" and "ventilator" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Now, when young ladies wander about the metropolis at this hour of the morning, and knock sleepy people up out of their…" (paragraph 5), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating protection of the vulnerable as central.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 26 to the story's treatment of greed and violence: "Violence of temper approaching to mania has been hereditary in the men of the family, and in my step-father's case it had, I believe, been intensified by his long residence in the tropics." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 26) develops greed and violence: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Its words

"intensified" and "approaching" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "My step-father learned of the engagement when my sister returned, and offered no objection to the marriage; but within…" (paragraph 30), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating greed and violence as central.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 60 shapes its tone: "It is my belief that she died of pure fear and nervous shock, though what it was that frightened her I cannot imagine." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "frightened" and "imagine" (paragraph 60) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to protection of the vulnerable: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 233 shapes its tone: "Then he turned down the lamp, and we were left in darkness." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "darkness" and "turned" (paragraph 233) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to greed and violence: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 116 to the story's treatment of protection of the vulnerable: "My companion sat in the front of the trap, his arms folded, his hat pulled down over his eyes, and his chin sunk upon his breast, buried in the deepest thought." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 116) develops protection of the vulnerable: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Its words "companion" and "thought" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Our client of the morning had hurried forward to meet us with a face which spoke her joy." (paragraph 126), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating protection of the vulnerable as central.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 132 shapes its tone: "Some scaffolding had been erected against the end wall, and the stone-work had been broken into, but there were no signs of any workmen at the moment of our visit." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "scaffolding" and "erected" (paragraph 132) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to greed and violence: Roylott dies by his own weapon. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 173 to the story's treatment of greed and violence: "We had walked several times up and down the lawn, neither Miss Stoner nor myself liking to break in upon his thoughts before he roused himself from his reverie." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 173) develops greed and violence: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Its words "thoughts" and "neither" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "At dusk we saw Dr. Grimesby Roylott drive past, his huge form looming up beside the little figure of the lad who drove…" (paragraph 195), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating greed and violence as central.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 52 to the story's treatment of greed and violence: "It is my strong impression that I heard it, and yet, among the crash of the gale and the creaking of an old house, I may possibly have been deceived.'" Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 52) develops greed and violence: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Its words

"impression" and "deceived" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "It is my belief that she died of pure fear and nervous shock, though what it was that frightened her I cannot imagine." (paragraph 60), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating greed and violence as central.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from paragraph 17 to the story's treatment of protection of the vulnerable: "Sir, I can stand this strain no longer; I shall go mad if it continues." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 17) develops protection of the vulnerable: Roylott dies by his own weapon. Its words "continues" and "longer" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "As to reward, my profession is its own reward; but you are at liberty to defray whatever expenses I may be put to, at…" (paragraph 19), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating protection of the vulnerable as central.

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] In the line "She had a considerable sum of money—not less than £1000 a year—and this she bequeathed to Dr.", what does "bequeathed" most nearly mean?

    A. an inadequate payment
    B. extend out or project in space
    C. incapable of being passed
    D. leave or give by will after one's death

    Key: D (leave or give by will after one's death)

33. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] In the line "It is evident, therefore, that if both girls had married, this beauty would have had a mere pittance, while even one of them would cripple him to a very serious extent.", what does "pittance" most nearly mean?

    A. leave or give by will after one's death
    B. extend out or project in space
    C. an inadequate payment
    D. incapable of being passed

    Key: C (an inadequate payment)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18	recall 10, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	5, 6, 8, 3, 10, 4, 2, 7, 9, 1, 15, 11, 12, 14, 19, 17, 16, 20	recall 10, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	6, 10, 8, 7, 2, 3, 5, 14, 13, 15, 14, 12, 11, 21, 17, 22, 23, 24	recall 7, inference 6, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	8, 2, 3, 10, 9, 7, 14, 12, 11, 14, 15, 13, 25, 21, 19, 16, 24, 23	recall 6, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	3, 2, 7, 4, 8, 12, 14, 11, 14, 13, 15, 26, 22, 16, 25, 24, 27, 18	recall 5, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	3, 6, 1, 12, 14, 15, 14, 28, 21, 25, 17, 22, 16, 29, 20, 23, 30, 18	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Freshman		

	9, 8, 1, 11, 13, 15, 14, 22, 25, 16, 28, 21, 19, 18, 30, 29, 31, 23	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	32, 4, 3, 14, 15, 14, 16, 22, 26, 17, 25, 28, 18, 27, 24, 30, 29, 20	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 6, synthesis 6
College Junior	2, 1, 33, 12, 14, 26, 16, 25, 19, 28, 22, 23, 24, 18, 31, 20, 27, 29	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 7
College Senior	3, 14, 12, 14, 21, 28, 19, 22, 25, 16, 18, 31, 30, 23, 27, 29, 20, 24	recall 1, inference 3, analysis 6, synthesis 8
Graduate / PhD	10, 14, 28, 21, 17, 25, 19, 16, 26, 22, 23, 29, 20, 30, 18, 27, 31, 24	recall 1, inference 1, analysis 8, synthesis 8

Final paper

The Adventure of the Speckled Band: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Arthur Conan Doyle develops reason and deduction across The Adventure of the Speckled Band. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in The Adventure of the Speckled Band and argue how its meaning changes over the story and why that change matters to greed and violence.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in The Adventure of the Speckled Band. Argue whether the story judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether The Adventure of the Speckled Band finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of protection of the vulnerable. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 4 quotations from at least two parts of the story. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.	Specific, arguable and precise; it organizes every section.	Clear and arguable, but broad in places.	States a topic or a summary more than an argument.	Missing, or restates the prompt.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.	Accurate, well-chosen quotations from across the work, all cited; meets the requirement.	Accurate and cited, but clustered in one part of the work.	Too few quotations, or some inaccurate or uncited.	Little or no quoted evidence.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.	Explains how specific words, structure and devices create meaning; weighs a	Explains the evidence, with some close reading.	Mostly summary; the link to the claim is asserted, not shown.	Summary only.

			competing reading.			
Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.	Each paragraph advances the argument; transitions show logic.	Logical order with minor jumps.	Order is loose; paragraphs repeat or drift.	No discernible structure.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.	Formal, precise, present tense; MLA format; virtually error-free.	Formal with a few errors that do not obscure meaning.	Informal or error-prone in ways that distract.	Errors obscure meaning.

Exemplar paragraph: Roylott is destroyed by the weapon he created. The text makes this visible when it says “Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent” (The Adventure of the Speckled Band, paragraph 245). Holmes drives the snake back, and it kills Roylott; Holmes concludes, "Violence does, in truth, recoil upon the violent.". A full paper would carry this reading through the beginning, middle and end, and answer the strongest competing reading.

Essay assignments

Essay: Reason and deduction

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Adventure of the Speckled Band teaches about reason and deduction. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Arthur Conan Doyle develops reason and deduction in The Adventure of the Speckled Band. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Arthur Conan Doyle develops reason and deduction across The Adventure of the Speckled Band. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Adventure of the Speckled Band (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of reason and deduction. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of reason and deduction in The Adventure of the Speckled Band. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Arthur Conan Doyle's choices in The Adventure of the Speckled Band (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of reason and deduction, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Adventure of the Speckled Band's treatment of reason and deduction in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on reason and deduction in The Adventure of the Speckled Band that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on reason and deduction in The Adventure of the Speckled Band. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about reason and deduction in The Adventure of the Speckled Band, engaging at least four

scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on reason and deduction in The Adventure of the Speckled Band, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Greed and violence

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Adventure of the Speckled Band teaches about greed and violence. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Arthur Conan Doyle develops greed and violence in The Adventure of the Speckled Band. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Arthur Conan Doyle develops greed and violence across The Adventure of the Speckled Band. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Adventure of the Speckled Band (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of greed and violence. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of greed and violence in The Adventure of the Speckled Band. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Arthur Conan Doyle's choices in The Adventure of the Speckled Band (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of greed and violence, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

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Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Protection of the vulnerable

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Adventure of the Speckled Band teaches about protection of the vulnerable. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Arthur Conan Doyle develops protection of the vulnerable in The Adventure of the Speckled Band. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Arthur Conan Doyle develops protection of the vulnerable across The Adventure of the Speckled Band. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Adventure of the Speckled Band (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of protection of the vulnerable. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of protection of the vulnerable in The Adventure of the Speckled Band. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Arthur Conan Doyle's choices in The Adventure of the Speckled Band (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of protection of the vulnerable, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Adventure of the Speckled Band's treatment of protection of the vulnerable in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

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Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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